

Harborage Marina

Lease Extension

Public Services & Infrastructure Committee
April 9, 2026





History

- In 1986, a City-wide referendum authorized the City to enter into a 25-year submerged land lease for the development of a marina within Bayboro Harbor.
- In 1999, Harborage Marina assumed the 1986 lease.
- In 2004, a City-wide referendum authorized the City to enter into a new 30-year lease for the marina.
- In 2007, the City and Harborage Marina entered into the new lease, which expanded the original premises from ± 11.4 acres to ± 13.424 acres and obligated Harborage Marina to construct new “mega-yacht” slips.

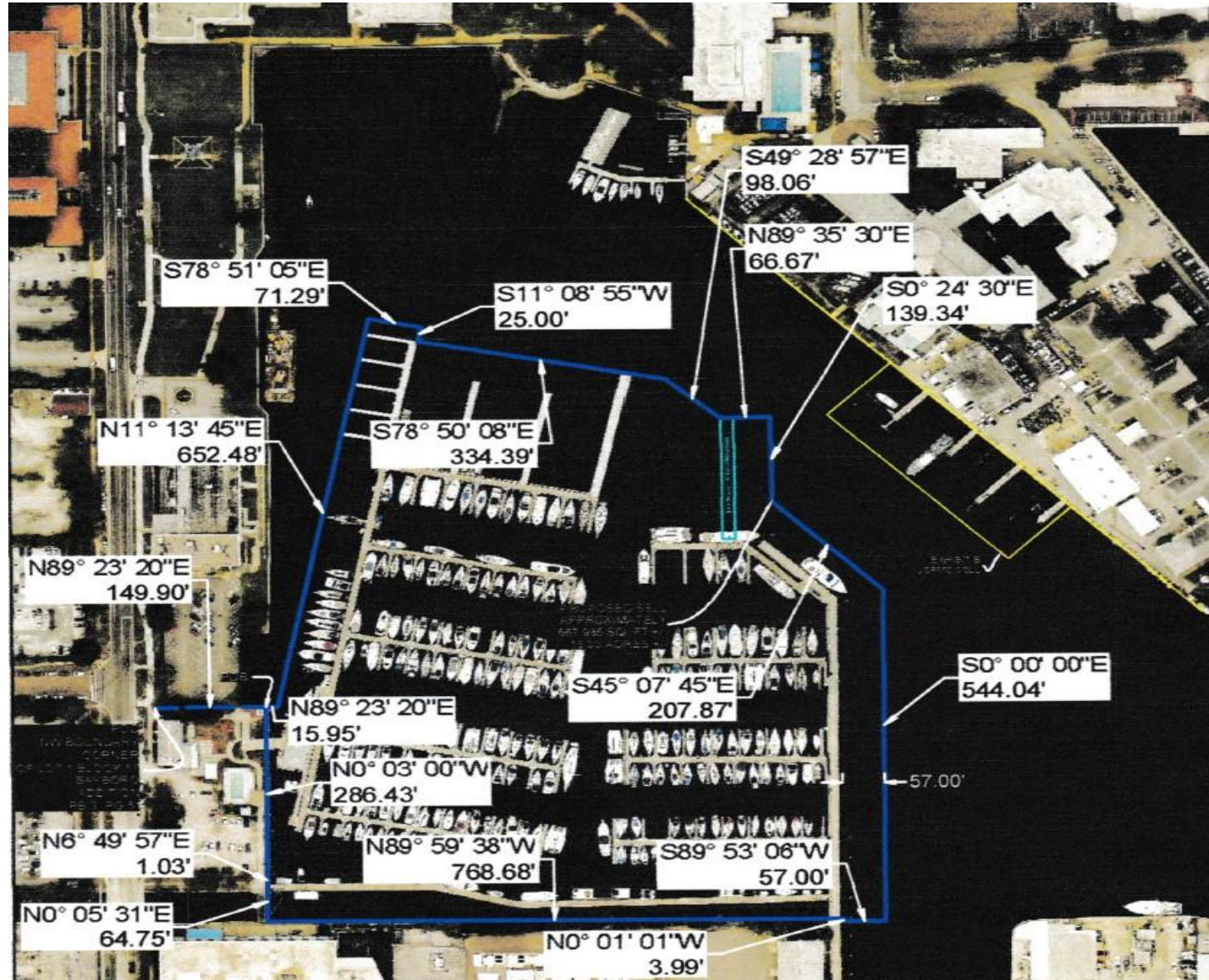


History

- The 2007 lease has been amended five times to provide: 1) extended lease terms for the mega-yacht slip rentals; 2) extension to the construction schedule for the mega-yacht slips; 3) amendments to the due dates for the lessee to cause an estoppel to be terminated and a leasehold mortgage to be satisfied; 4) an extension of the lease term to the full 30 years as authorized by the 2004 referendum.
- In 2018, a City-wide referendum authorized a fifth amendment to the lease, providing a new 30-year lease term, expansion of the premises to ± 15.33 acres, and requiring Harborage Marina to construct a new 200' dock and to perform electrical upgrades.



Illustration of Leased Premises







Request for Lease Term Extension

- In November 2025, Harborage Marina requested an extension of the current lease term to a new 30-year term, for the purpose of investing an estimated \$2 million into the marina over the next several years.
- The proposed improvements include upgrades to the existing docks and dock infrastructure by extending docks and adding boat lifts to accommodate additional boaters and larger vessels, and upgrades to the restroom facilities.
- The request for a new lease term of 30 years requires the approval of a City-wide referendum.





Initial Draft Ballot Language

Authorizing Amendment of Harborage Marina Lease to Extend Term to 30 Years and Require Improvements

May City Council approve amendment of the lease of City-owned submerged lands at Harborage Marina subject to conditions in ordinance ____? Such amendment would extend the term of the lease to 30 years and require the tenant to construct new improvements at no cost to the City, including 200 linear feet of docks, boat lifts, and expanded bathrooms. Those improvements would be owned by the City at the end of the lease.

YES

NO



Timing

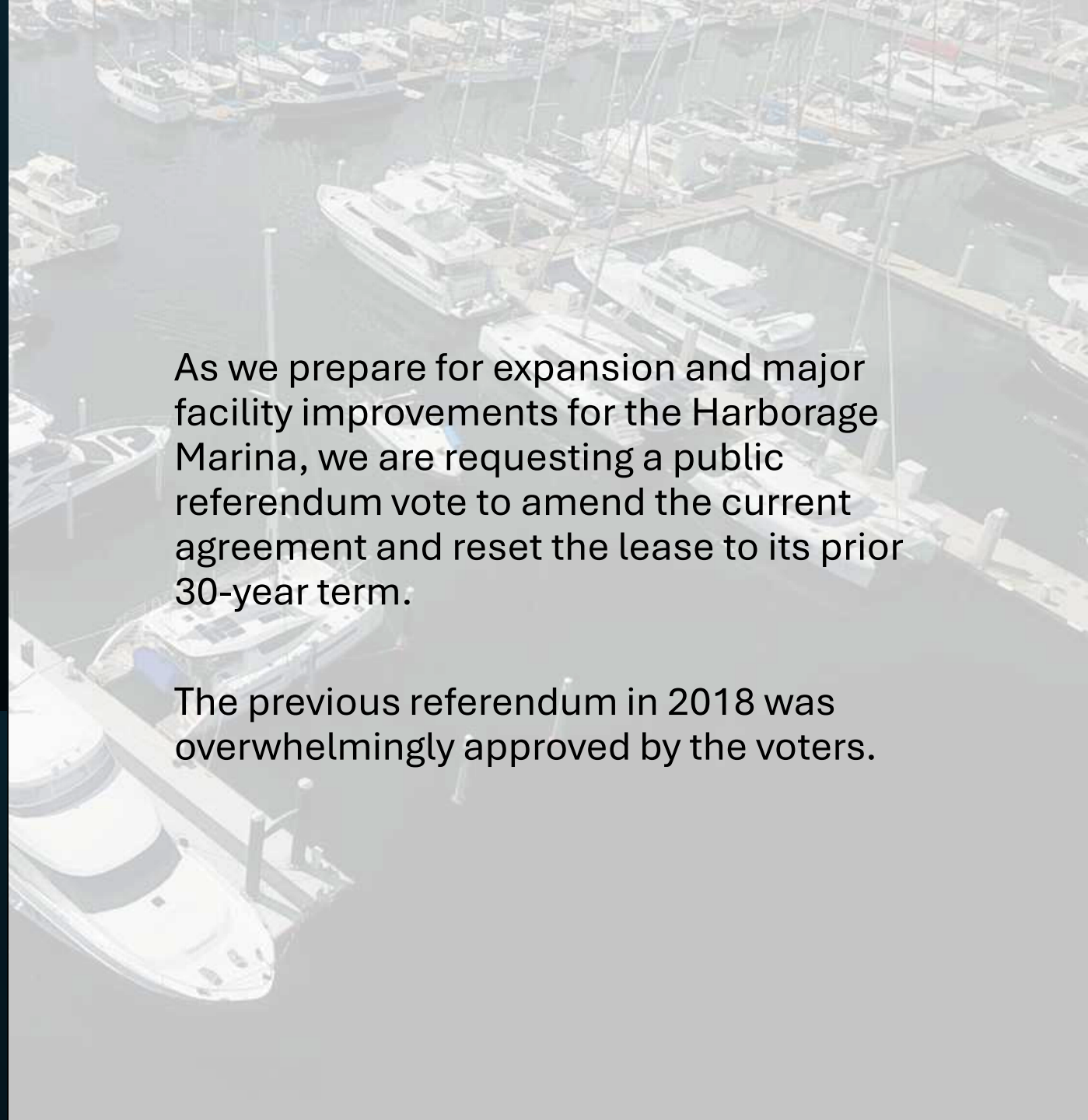
- Latest possible timeline for a November 2026 City-wide referendum to provide a new 30-year lease term:
 - April: Finalize draft ordinance and begin preparation of notice to residents and business owners within 200 yards of affected property, mailed 35 days before first reading of referendum ordinance
 - June-July: Approve ordinance(s) to place referendum on ballot
 - November: Referendum occurs as part of 2026 municipal general election



Harborage Marina Request for Referendum

As we prepare for expansion and major facility improvements for the Harborage Marina, we are requesting a public referendum vote to amend the current agreement and reset the lease to its prior 30-year term.

The previous referendum in 2018 was overwhelmingly approved by the voters.





History of Partnership

For the last 27 years of its almost 40-year existence, we have successfully operated the Harborage Marina as a dedicated partner with the City of St. Petersburg and its citizens.

The Harborage Marina is a major revenue generator for the city. In FY2025, its annual lease contribution was \$671,000 with zero investment from the taxpayers.

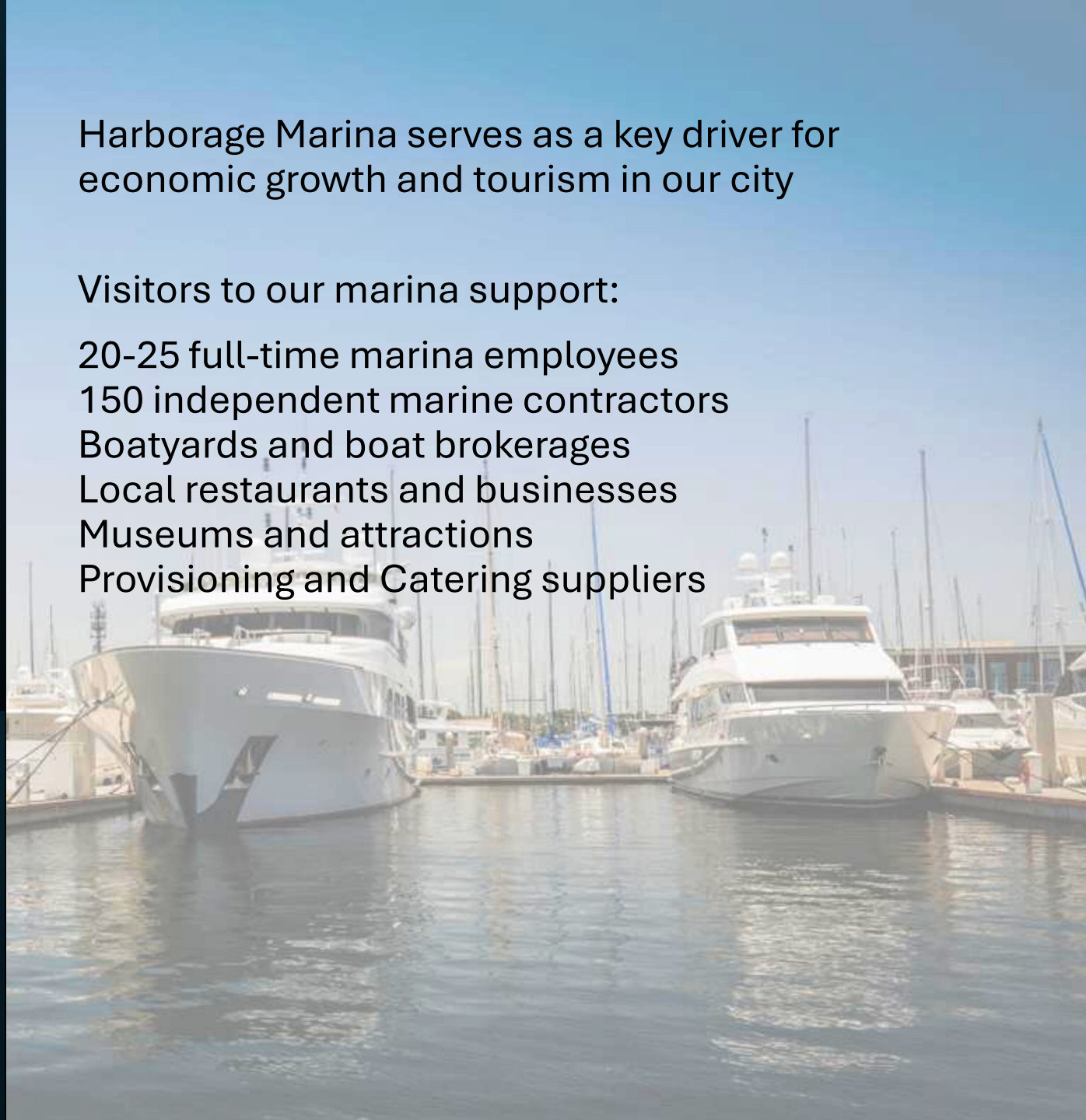


Economic Impact

Harborage Marina serves as a key driver for economic growth and tourism in our city

Visitors to our marina support:

- 20-25 full-time marina employees
- 150 independent marine contractors
- Boatyards and boat brokerages
- Local restaurants and businesses
- Museums and attractions
- Provisioning and Catering suppliers





Successful History of Marina Expansion

1989 Original Marina Construction
(Florida Power)



2016 Mega Dock Expansion
(Harborage Marina)

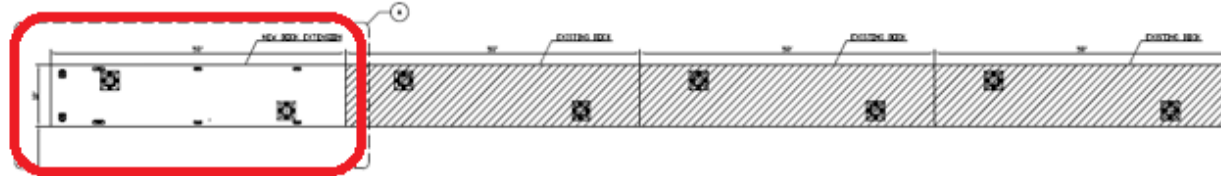


2022 Floating Breakwater Extension
(Harborage Marina)

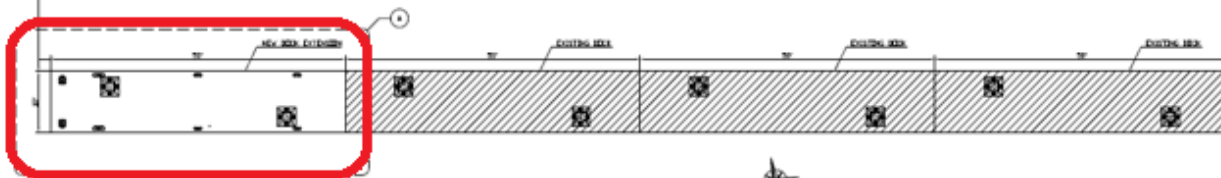




Proposed dock extension and boat lifts



**Proposed extensions
200 linear feet new dock**



BLUEWATER
MARINE SYSTEMS

DESIGN	07/23/20	
DATE		
BY		
CHK		
APP'D		
HARBORAGE MARINA DOCK EXTENSION		
REV	1	0
DATE		
SHEET 1 OF 2		





Harborage Marina – March 2026





Justification for Extension

A new 30-year term makes it financially feasible for the multi-million-dollar investment required for expansion and improvements to the 40-year-old facility.

Enables an immediate investment of \$2.15 million

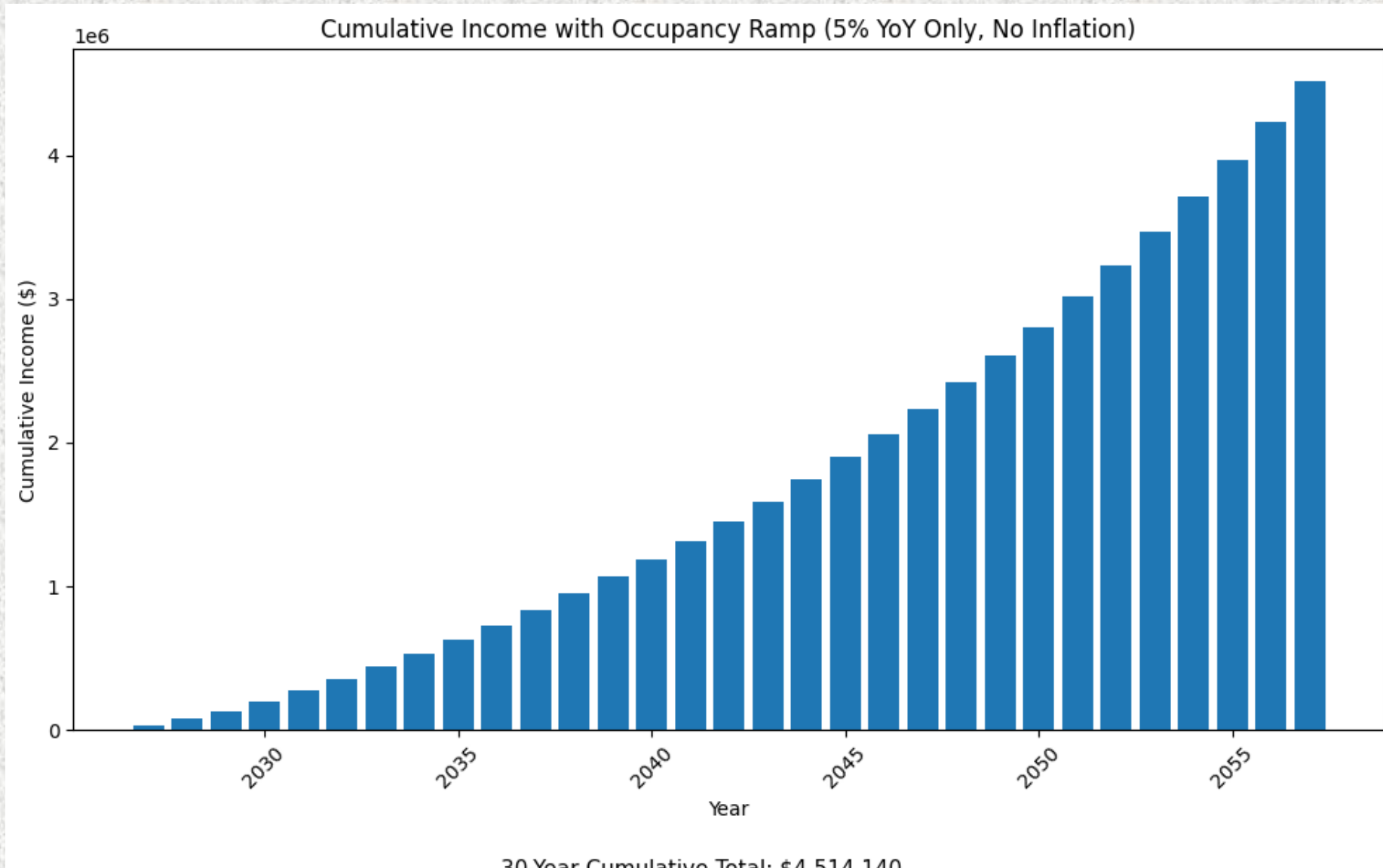
\$1M
200' feet of new dock w/ fire suppression, water, electric

\$650K
Installation of boat lifts

\$500K
Expanded Restrooms



This chart shows cumulative financial benefit to the city of \$4,514,140 from the extended docks and lifts.





Continuing Focus on Facility Improvements and Resiliency

Annual Capital Investment
currently averages \$250K-\$500K/year
not including special projects

Upcoming facility needs:

- Main building roof replacement
- Ongoing dock improvements including necessary flotation replacement
- Electrical upgrades
- Replace existing fireboxes with standpipes per SPFD
- Innovative hurricane resiliency projects such as piling sleeve extensions (2025)



How does Harborage Marina support the local economy?

Through continuing partnerships with local contractors and professionals, including:

Blue Water Marine
R&B Electric
EMP Industries
WJArchitects
The St. Petersburg Innovation District
Flowable Logistics
Freedom Boat Club
Woods Consulting and Engineering
Enterprise Marine, LLC
Gulf and Bay Dredging, LLC
Decks and Docks St Petersburg
Pinellas Fasteners



How does Harborage Marina support the community?

Shirley Proctor Puller Foundation

"Their leadership has provided critical support for our work in advancing literacy and workforce readiness for the students in South St. Petersburg."

Bridgette Heller, Shirley Proctor Fuller Foundation

St Petersburg Innovation District

"The proposed extension is thoughtfully designed to complement existing harbor activities, ensuring continued balance among recreational, commercial, and research-related maritime uses."

Alison Barlow, Executive Director

SailFuture

"The Harborage has supported SailFuture and the work we do for youth at risk in St. Petersburg in meaningful and consistent ways."

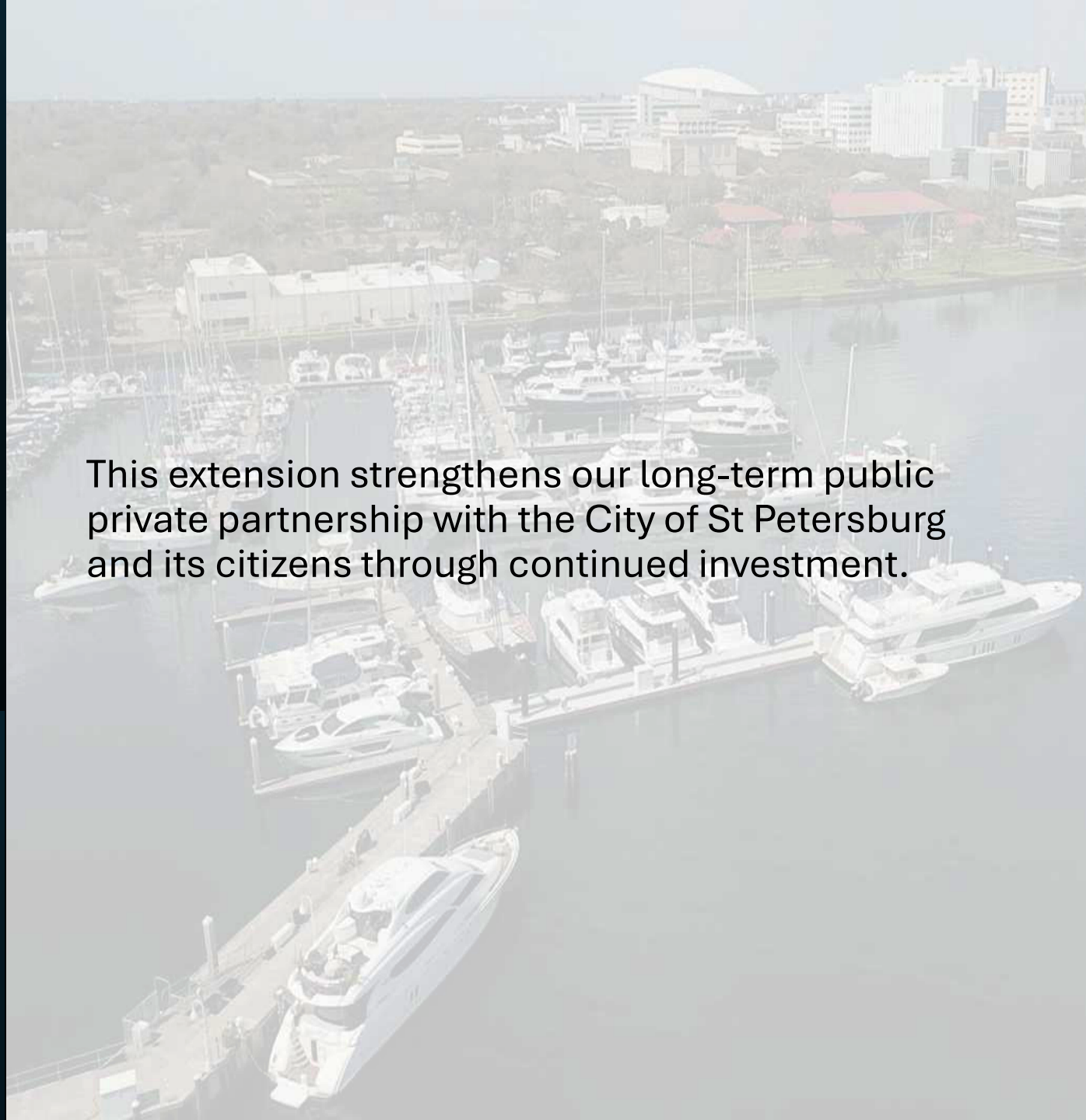
Through this partnership, SailFuture Academy students have gained access to real-world learning opportunities and internships within a professional maritime environment."

Michael Long, Executive Director



Vision for the Future

This extension strengthens our long-term public private partnership with the City of St Petersburg and its citizens through continued investment.



Thank You

